

From breeze to gale

Winds are simply the air around us moving. Sometimes the air moves so slowly that the wind is too weak to lift a feather. At other times, it moves so fast that trees and walls are blown down. Strong winds can be very dangerous. The Beaufort wind scale divides winds into 13 “forces.” On the Beaufort wind scale, 0 is calm and 12 is a hurricane.



Force 2: Light breeze

When a light breeze blows, the weather is usually clear. You can feel air on your face, hear leaves rustle, and see plumes of smoke gently drifting.



Force 5: Fresh breeze

During a fresh breeze, clouds often start to drift across the sky, and small trees sway. Crested waves form on lakes.